

JAMES HARRISON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Full Stack Engineer with 14 years of experience building scalable web applications and leading technical initiatives across early-stage startups and established fintech companies. I started my career with PHP and jQuery, transitioned through the Node.js and React revolution, and now spend most of my time architecting systems, mentoring junior developers, and solving complex performance problems. I'm comfortable working in greenfield projects or untangling legacy codebases, and I genuinely enjoy the problem-solving aspect of infrastructure as much as frontend polish.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Full Stack Engineer

Fintech Solutions Ltd

www.fintechsolutions.co.uk

London, United Kingdom

March 2021 - Present

Led the architecture and implementation of a real-time trading platform handling 50,000+ concurrent users with sub-100ms latency requirements across microservices built in Node.js and Python.

Designed and implemented an event-driven system using RabbitMQ and Apache Kafka that reduced data reconciliation issues by 94% and enabled real-time portfolio updates for 200,000+ active accounts.

Mentored a team of 5 engineers through code reviews, technical design sessions, and pair programming, resulting in a 60% reduction in production incidents and significantly improved code quality across the codebase.

Established monitoring and observability practices using Datadog and custom logging solutions that cut mean time to detection for production issues from 45 minutes to 8 minutes.

Senior Full Stack Engineer

Velocity Digital

www.velocity.io

London, United Kingdom

August 2018 - February 2021

Owned the full-stack development of a customer analytics dashboard processing 100 million events daily, built with React, Express, and PostgreSQL, serving 500+ enterprise clients.

Migrated a monolithic Rails application to a microservices architecture using Docker and Kubernetes, improving deployment frequency from monthly to multiple times per day and reducing infrastructure costs by 38%.

Implemented comprehensive API rate limiting and caching strategies that improved response times by 65% and reduced database load significantly during peak traffic periods.

Drove adoption of TypeScript across the frontend team, preventing approximately 12-15 bugs per quarter that would have reached production and improving developer experience dramatically.

Full Stack Developer

StartupHub Technologies

www.startuphub.net

London, United Kingdom

June 2010 - July 2018

Developed and maintained multiple client-facing web applications in PHP and JavaScript, establishing coding standards and best practices that improved onboarding time for new developers from 3 weeks to 1 week.

Built and optimized a MySQL database schema for an e-commerce platform processing 10,000+ daily transactions, implementing indexing strategies and query optimization that reduced page load times from 3.2 seconds to 0.8 seconds.

Took ownership of DevOps responsibilities, setting up CI/CD pipelines with Jenkins and implementing automated testing, reducing manual QA time by 50% and improving release confidence.

Contributed to product roadmap decisions by working closely with product and design teams, shipping features used by over 50,000 active users and gathering user feedback for iterative improvements.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Manchester

Manchester, United Kingdom

2006 - 2010

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, PHP, SQL, HTML, CSS, Go

Frontend: React, Redux, Vue.js, Next.js, Material-UI, Jest, React Testing Library

Backend: Node.js, Express, Django, Rails, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis

DevOps & Infrastructure: Docker, Kubernetes, AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda), Google Cloud Platform, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Terraform

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, DynamoDB, Elasticsearch

Tools & Platforms: Git, Datadog, New Relic, Linux, Apache, Nginx, Grafana

Methodologies: Agile, Scrum, Test-Driven Development, Pair Programming, Microservices Architecture